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Summary: This report reviews the social entrepreneurship policy that the governments of Korea, Japan, China, the United Kingdom, the United States, France and Germany set out from January to December 2022 in six domains — regulation and law, finance, culture, support, human capital and markets — and analyses it in its context, against theory and in practice. No government created a legal form for social enterprise: Korea announced that certification would give way to registration, Japan's Workers' Cooperatives Act took effect in October, China's Charity Law revision was pending and Germany's pledges produced no bill. Finance was strongest where it ran through funds and public lenders, in Korea and the United States, while Germany's programme for social enterprises had spent nothing by October. Public purchasing was the least realised lever, social value in procurement was mostly promised, and culture and human capital were the thinnest domains.

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Social Entrepreneurship Policy in Korea, Japan, China, the United Kingdom, the United States, France and Germany, 2022

IFEED Institute for Entrepreneurial Ecosystem Development

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Social Entrepreneurship Policy in Korea, Japan, China, the United Kingdom, the United States, France and Germany, 2022

Abstract

This report reviews and analyses the social entrepreneurship policy of the governments of the Republic of Korea, Japan, the People's Republic of China, the United Kingdom, the United States, France and Germany in their own plans, laws, budgets and announcements. The policies are reviewed in six domains — regulation and law, finance, culture, support, human capital and markets — and analysed in their context, against theories of social entrepreneurship, social enterprise governance and social procurement, and in practice. No government created a legal form for social enterprise. Korea announced that certification would give way to registration, Japan's Workers' Cooperatives Act took effect on 1 October while a new corporate form was only to be studied, China's Charity Law revision was pending, and Germany's pledges on legal forms and a national strategy produced no bill or strategy. Finance was strongest where it ran through funds and public lenders: Korea formed its eighth social enterprise investment partnership, and the United States appropriated USD 324 million for its community development lenders' fund and allocated USD 5 billion of tax credits. The United Kingdom allocated GBP 44 million of dormant assets but left the causes for most of the new money undecided, and Germany's programme for social enterprises had spent nothing by October. Public purchasing was the least realised lever, work integration was strongest in France and the United States, culture and human capital were the thinnest domains, and governments reported outputs rather than social outcomes. The period covered is January to December 2022.

Keywords

social enterprise, social and solidarity economy, certification, worker cooperatives, dormant assets, community development finance, impact investment, social organisations, social value procurement, work integration, pay for success

JEL Classification

L31, L26, H44, I38, G23, O35

Entrepreneurship Policy Research Division, Institute for Entrepreneurial Ecosystem Development (IFEED).

1 INTRODUCTION

Key findings

- No government created a legal form for social enterprise: Korea planned to replace certification with registration, without a bill; Japan's Workers' Cooperatives Act took effect on 1 October; China's Charity Law revision was pending; and Germany's and France's reforms were pledged or announced.
- Finance was strongest through funds and public lenders: Korea formed an eighth social enterprise investment partnership of KRW 6.0 billion, and the United States appropriated USD 324 million for the CDFI Fund and allocated USD 5 billion of tax credits.
- Dormant money grew but was little spent: the United Kingdom allocated GBP 44 million but left the causes for about GBP 738 million undecided; Japan proposed equity from it, and Germany pledged its use.
- Much was announcement: Germany's REACT with impact had spent nothing by October, and France's line for the social and solidarity economy (SSE) for 2023 is shown only in the bill.
- Public purchasing was the least realised lever: Korea's central bodies bought 0.78 % of their purchases from social enterprises in 2021, a year of large vaccine purchases; the British Procurement Bill was pending; and Japan's preference was a study.
- Work integration was strongest in France, whose Finance Act for 2022 set EUR 1.3 billion for it, and in the United States, which ended subminimum wages on new and renewed AbilityOne contracts from 19 October.
- Culture was thin beyond Korea's contest, and governments reported outputs rather than social outcomes.

Social entrepreneurship differs from commercial entrepreneurship in measuring performance and mobilising people and money (Austin, Stevenson, & Wei-Skillern, 2006), and its hybrid logics create tensions over mission, finance and staff (Doherty, Haugh, & Lyon, 2014). Evidence from 26 countries finds it more likely where government activism is higher (Stephan, Uhlaner, & Stride, 2015). This report reviews the social entrepreneurship policy of Korea, Japan, China, the United Kingdom, the United States, France and Germany in the domains of the entrepreneurial ecosystem, and asks three questions:

1. What policies did each of these governments set out in each domain of social entrepreneurship in 2022?
2. How did the policies arise and how were they justified, how far were they valid in theory, and what had they achieved in practice by the end of the year?
3. What were their limitations, and what follows for policy?

The report draws on theories of social enterprise governance (Ebrahim, Battilana, & Mair, 2014), social impact bonds (Fraser, Tan, Lagarde, & Mays, 2018) and social procurement (Erridge, 2007). Section 2 reviews the policies of 2022 in six domains, Section 3 analyses them, and Sections 4 and 5 set out their limitations and implications. The report rests on the governments' own plans, laws, budgets, reports and announcements of 2022, with releases of the Japan Finance Corporation (Table 1); quotations from sources not in English are IFEED's translations.

Table 1: Government plans, laws, reports and announcements reviewed

Subject	Issuing bodies	Date and type	Period covered	Description
Korea				
Universities	MOEL	20 February 2022, press release	February 2022	Four universities.
Gwangju town	MOTIE	8 April 2022, press release	April 2022	Seventh town decided.
Purchasing	MOEL	27 April 2022, press release	2021–2022	2.77 % bought in 2021.
Partnership	MOEL	2 June 2022, press release	June 2022	Eighth partnership.
SVI screening	MOEL	15 September 2022, press release	September 2022	SVI for new type.
Certification	MOEL	21 December 2022, press releases	2022	Contest; survival rates.
Registration	MOTIE	21 December 2022, press release	December 2022	Registration planned.
Japan				
JFC loans	JFC	30 May 2022, news releases	2021–2022	8,134 loans in a half.
Basic Policy	Cabinet	7 June 2022, cabinet decision	June 2022	Support pledged.
Pay for success	Cabinet Office	21 July 2022, survey report	2022	100 projects.
Cooperatives Act	Diet	1 October 2022, act	October 2022	Non-profit form.
Cooperatives	MHLW	3 October 2022, press release	October 2022	Act in force; forums.
Start-up plan	Cabinet Secretariat	28 November 2022, plan	November 2022	Items to study.
Dormant deposits	Cabinet Office	16 December 2022, policy paper	December 2022	Equity proposed.
China				
Service purchase	MOF	25 March 2022, notice	2022	Fields; guardrails.
Central grant	MCA Office	24 April 2022, notice, plan	2022	Grants by competition.
Graduate jobs	MCA; MOE; MOHRSS	8 July 2022, joint notice	July 2022	Jobs; incubation.
Grades	MCA Office	26 December 2022, notice	December 2022	Grade plaques.
NPC agenda	NPC	26 December 2022, web article	December 2022	Charity Law on agenda.
United Kingdom				
Levelling up	DLUHC	2 February 2022, white paper	February 2022	To be considered.
Allocations	DCMS	8 February 2022, press release	February 2022	GBP 44 million.
Dormant Assets Act	Parliament	24 February 2022, act	February 2022	Wider scheme enacted.
Procurement Bill	Cabinet Office	12 May 2022, news story	May 2022	Reserved competitions.
Consultation	DCMS	15 July 2022, consultation	2022	Causes consulted on.

Subject	Issuing bodies	Date and type	Period covered	Description
CIC Regulator	CIC Regulator	5 August 2022, annual report	2021–2022	Webinars.
Readiness Fund	DCMS	1 September 2022, guidance	September 2022	Bids invited.
United States				
SIPPRA	Treasury	24 February 2022, notices	2022	Two agreements.
Proclamations	President	15 April 2022, proclamations	2022	Service; disability.
AmeriCorps match	AmeriCorps	5 May 2022, request	2022	Match rules reviewed.
Wage rule	AbilityOne	21 July 2022, final rule	2022	Wage floor phased in.
Inflation Reduction Act	Congress	16 August 2022, act	August 2022	Elective payment.
Certification	CDFI Fund	4 October 2022, announcement	2022	Tests previewed.
Tax credits	CDFI Fund	28 October 2022, press release	October 2022	USD 5 billion.
Appropriations	Congress	29 December 2022, act	December 2022	USD 324 million.
France				
SSE minister	Prime Minister	29 July 2022, decree	July 2022	Duties; Treasury.
Roadmaps	Prime Minister	31 August 2022, roadmaps	August 2022	ESUS to simplify.
SSE budget	Assembly	5 October 2022, opinion	October 2022	SSE line in the bill.
Labour budget	Senate	17 November 2022, report	November 2022	IAE credits.
Finance Act	Parliament	30 December 2022, law	December 2022	SSE spending report.
Purchasing plan	Ecology ministry	2022, plan	2022	Social clause target.
Germany				
Economic Report	Government	26 January 2022, report	January 2022	Laws pledged.
Social innovation	BMBF	27 April 2022, press releases	2022	Commissioner.
Start-up Strategy	Government	28 July 2022, paper	July 2022	Own strategy promised.
Share loans	BMWSB	4 October 2022, press release	October 2022	KfW loans launched.
Spending answer	Government	15 November 2022, answer	October 2022	No spending on title.

Source: The plans, laws, reports and announcements listed. Periods covered and descriptions: IFEED.

Note: Where a source has several parts, citations name the part (for example, release, plan, notice or annex) before the page. Citations use the abbreviations below. Abbreviations: BMBF, Federal Ministry of Education and Research; BMWSB, Federal Ministry for Housing, Urban Development and Building; CDFI, community development financial institution; CDFI Fund, Community Development Financial Institutions Fund; CIC, community interest company; DCMS, Department for Digital, Culture, Media and Sport; DLA, local support scheme; DLUHC, Department for Levelling Up, Housing and Communities; ESUS, solidarity enterprise of social utility; FR, Federal Register; IAE, integration through economic activity; IPO, initial public offering; JFC, Japan Finance Corporation; KfW, Germany's public development bank; KoSEA, Korea Social Enterprise Promotion Agency; MCA, Ministry of Civil Affairs; MHLW, Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare; MOE, Ministry of Education; MOEL, Ministry of Employment and Labor; MOF, Ministry of Finance; MOHRSS, Ministry of Human Resources and Social Security; MOTIE, Ministry of Trade, Industry and Energy; NPC, National People's Congress; NPO, non-profit organisation; REACT, Recovery Assistance for Cohesion and the Territories of Europe (in REACT with impact); SIPPRA, Social Impact Partnerships to Pay for Results Act; SME, small and medium-sized enterprise; SSE, social and solidarity economy; SVI, Social Value Index; US, United States; VCSE, voluntary, community and social enterprise.

2 REVIEW OF SOCIAL ENTREPRENEURSHIP POLICIES

This section reviews the key policies of 2022 in six domains of the entrepreneurial ecosystem: regulation and law; finance; culture; institutional support; human capital; and markets, including initial public offerings (IPO) and exit.

2.1 REGULATION AND LAW

No government created a legal form for social enterprise; most changes were announced, studied or pending.

2.1.1 KOREA: SOCIAL ENTERPRISE CERTIFICATION AND REGISTRATION

MOEL decided on 15 September to use the Social Value Index (SVI) to judge the social purpose of the innovative type (MOEL, 15 September 2022, p. 1), and on 16 December the Regulatory Reform Committee confirmed a plan to replace certification with registration, without a bill (MOTIE, 21 December 2022, pp. 1–2). This was a mixed policy: the SVI widens entry, but registration was only announced and would drop much screening, while status alone does only part of the work against mission drift (Ebrahim et al., 2014).

2.1.2 JAPAN: THE WORKERS' COOPERATIVES ACT AND DORMANT DEPOSITS

The Workers' Cooperatives Act took effect on 1 October with a non-profit rule and a specified type that bars dividends (National Diet of Japan, 1 October 2022, Arts. 3, 94-2); a corporate form for private bodies with public roles and an impact start-up certification were only to be studied (Cabinet Office of Japan, 7 June 2022, p. 12; Cabinet Secretariat of Japan, 28 November 2022, p. 19), and a dormant deposits amendment was proposed (Cabinet Office of Japan, 16 December 2022, p. 9). This was a mixed policy: the new non-profit form is in force, but the rest were studies or proposals.

2.1.3 CHINA: THE CHARITY LAW REVISION AND SERVICE PURCHASE RULES

A draft revision of the Charity Law was on the NPC Standing Committee's agenda for 27 to 30 December, its outcome not shown (National People's Congress, 26 December 2022, para. 2), and the MOF barred the use of purchase of services for disguised borrowing or employment (MOF, 25 March 2022, Part II(4)). This was a mixed policy: the purchase rules are in force, but the Charity Law revision was pending, and trading social enterprises gained no status.

2.1.4 UNITED KINGDOM: THE DORMANT ASSETS ACT 2022

The Act of 24 February provides for widening the dormant assets scheme, its main provisions to commence by regulations (Parliament of the United Kingdom, 24 February 2022, long title, s. 34); the consultation on causes for about GBP 738 million in England closed on 9 October with no order made (DCMS, 15 July 2022, release, and consultation page). This was a mixed policy: once commenced, the Act will enlarge a source of social investment outside the budget, but the causes were undecided.

2.1.5 UNITED STATES: CDFI CERTIFICATION AND ELECTIVE PAYMENT

On 4 October the CDFI Fund previewed stricter certification tests for community development financial institutions (CDFI), warning that some might no longer qualify (CDFI Fund, 4 October 2022, advance look); the Inflation Reduction Act will let tax-exempt bodies take clean energy credits as direct payment from 2023 (United States Congress, 16 August 2022, sec. 13801). This was a mixed policy: elective payment is enacted, but the certification revision was a preview, and social enterprises gained no federal status.

2.1.6 FRANCE: THE ESUS APPROVAL AND THE FINANCE ACT FOR 2023

The roadmap of 31 August announced an evaluation of SSE tools and a simpler approval of solidarity enterprises of social utility (ESUS) (Prime Minister of France, 31 August 2022, p. 35), and the Finance Act for 2023 requires a report on SSE spending by 30 June 2023 (Parliament of France, 30 December 2022, Art. 185). This was a mixed policy: the report is enacted, but a simpler approval of the one status that marks social enterprises in French law was only announced.

2.1.7 GERMANY: THE ANNUAL ECONOMIC REPORT'S LEGAL PLEDGES

The Annual Economic Report of 26 January pledged a legal framework for common-good-oriented business and companies with tied assets, and the use of dormant accounts (Federal Government of Germany, 26 January 2022, para. 154). This was a poor policy: no pledge became a bill, and Germany offered neither a form nor the governance that should go with one (Ebrahim et al., 2014).

2.2 FINANCE: GRANTS, FUNDING AND FINANCIAL INFRASTRUCTURE

Finance turned on funds, dormant money, public lenders and budget lines.

2.2.1 KOREA: THE EIGHTH SOCIAL ENTERPRISE INVESTMENT PARTNERSHIP

The eighth social enterprise investment partnership, of KRW 6.0 billion with KRW 1.5 billion of private money, was formed on 29 April, at least 60 % for social and related enterprises (MOEL, 2 June 2022, pp. 1–2). This was a good policy: a partnership that must invest in social enterprises draws private money into equity and eases their constraints of money (Austin et al., 2006).

2.2.2 JAPAN: JFC SOCIAL BUSINESS LOANS AND DORMANT DEPOSIT EQUITY

In the first half of fiscal year 2022 the JFC made 8,134 social business loans (127.4 % of a year earlier) but 333 to NPO corporations (74.2 %) (JFC, 30 May 2022, release of 29 November, p. 1), and equity of JPY 0.5 billion to JPY 1.0 billion from dormant deposits was proposed (Cabinet Office of Japan, 16 December 2022, p. 11). This was a mixed policy: the lender lent more, but lending to NPO corporations fell, and the equity was a proposal.

2.2.3 CHINA: THE CENTRAL GRANT TO SOCIAL ORGANISATIONS

The MCA's central grant funded social organisations by competition, up to CNY 800,000 a project in its largest class (General Office of the Ministry of Civil Affairs, 24 April 2022, plan, Parts II–III), and social organisations renting public premises were to receive larger rent reductions (MCA, MOE, & MOHRSS, 8 July 2022, Part II(3)). This was a mixed policy: the grant and rent relief reach services at

the margin of the market, but they support social organisations and buy services rather than build social enterprises.

2.2.4 UNITED KINGDOM: DORMANT ASSETS ALLOCATIONS

DCMS allocated GBP 44 million of English dormant assets on 8 February: GBP 20 million to Access, the Foundation for Social Investment, for finance for up to 1,000 charities and social enterprises, GBP 20 million to Youth Futures Foundation for youth employment and GBP 4 million to Fair4All Finance for affordable loans (DCMS, 8 February 2022, release). This was a mixed policy: the allocation to Access adds patient capital for social enterprises outside the budget, but GBP 24 million went to youth employment and personal loans, and most of the new dormant money had no causes at the end of the year (Section 2.1.4).

2.2.5 UNITED STATES: CDFI FUND APPROPRIATIONS AND TAX CREDITS

Congress appropriated USD 324 million for the CDFI Fund for fiscal year 2023 (United States Congress, 29 December 2022, 136 Stat. 4653), and on 28 October the Fund allocated more than USD 5 billion of New Markets Tax Credits to 107 community development entities (CDFI Fund, 28 October 2022, release). This was a good policy: enacted appropriations and allocated credits are directed to lenders and entities that must keep a community development mission.

2.2.6 FRANCE: ACTION 04 OF PROGRAMME 305 AND IMPACT CONTRACTS

The bill for 2023 held action 04, the State's SSE line, at EUR 19.22 million of commitments, up 0.093 %, and raised payments to EUR 20.69 million, up 7.50 %, while its part for developing the SSE fell from EUR 7.3 million to EUR 5.54 million, and EUR 3.5 million for impact contracts went unspent (National Assembly of France, 5 October 2022, pp. 8, 10). This was a mixed policy: the line was kept, but it is small, its 2023 amounts are shown only as the bill's, and unspent impact credits accord with the limited evidence on social impact bonds (Fraser et al., 2018).

2.2.7 GERMANY: REACT WITH IMPACT AND KFW COOPERATIVE SHARE LOANS

REACT with impact, a title for common-good-oriented SMEs, had spent nothing by October against EUR 9 million expected (Federal Government of Germany, 15 November 2022, p. 4), while KfW loans for shares in housing cooperatives began on 4 October (BMWSB, 4 October 2022, release). This was a mixed policy: the share loans began, but the programme had not started, and the activism with which social entrepreneurship is more likely (Stephan et al., 2015) was mostly announced.

2.3 CULTURE

Culture was a thin domain: Korea held a contest; elsewhere it was mostly outreach and statements.

2.3.1 KOREA: THE SOCIAL VENTURE CONTEST

MOEL's Social Venture Contest drew 615 teams and made 39 awards on 23 November; winners were to receive expert mentoring, and those in the general and global categories could enter the

social enterprise start-up programme, with business funding, without further screening (MOEL, 21 December 2022, release of 23 November, pp. 1, 3). This was a good policy: awards backed by mentoring and programme entry give social entrepreneurs recognition and support, though no measure of public awareness was reported.

2.3.2 JAPAN: THE WORKER COOPERATIVE FORUMS AND THE BASIC POLICY

MHLW held forums in seven places on the new worker cooperatives (MHLW, 3 October 2022, release), and the Basic Policy of 7 June promised support for social entrepreneurs through a culture of giving (Cabinet Office of Japan, 7 June 2022, p. 12). This was a mixed policy: the forums spread a new form, but the pledge had no programme.

2.3.3 CHINA: EVALUATION GRADES OF SOCIAL ORGANISATIONS

The MCA's General Office standardised the plaques of social organisations' evaluation grades, a basis for preferential policies (General Office of the Ministry of Civil Affairs, 26 December 2022, opening paragraph). This was a mixed policy: the grades give a recognised standing, but to social organisations rather than to enterprises that trade for social aims.

2.3.4 UNITED KINGDOM: LEVELLING UP WHITE PAPER AND CIC WEBINARS

The white paper of 2 February promised to consider how to encourage social entrepreneurship in left-behind places (DLUHC, 2 February 2022, p. 216), and the Regulator of community interest companies (CIC) ran webinars on the differences between CICs and charities (Office of the Regulator of Community Interest Companies, 5 August 2022, p. 4). This was a mixed policy: the outreach helps founders choose a form, but the white paper only promised consideration.

2.3.5 UNITED STATES: PROCLAMATIONS 10370 AND 10460

The proclamations of 15 April and 30 September credited AmeriCorps with removing barriers to service and pointed to funding for non-profits that hire people with disabilities (President of the United States, 15 April 2022, 87 FR 23749, and Proclamation 10460, 87 FR 60251). This was a poor policy: they are statements without instruments, and no award, label or campaign for social enterprises followed.

2.3.6 FRANCE: DECREE 2022-1059 AND THE ROADMAP FOR THE SSE

Decree 2022-1059 charged the Secretary of State with promoting the SSE (Prime Minister of France, 29 July 2022, Art. 1), but the roadmap of 31 August stated aims without measures (Prime Minister of France, 31 August 2022, p. 35), and the bill for 2023 cut the line for the SSE abroad from EUR 0.3 million to EUR 0.135 million (National Assembly of France, 5 October 2022, p. 11). This was a mixed policy: a duty to promote the SSE is in force, but the roadmap was a statement, and the bill more than halved the line abroad.

2.3.7 GERMANY: ANNUAL ECONOMIC REPORT AND START-UP STRATEGY

The Annual Economic Report called social enterprises part of a modern corporate culture (Federal Government of Germany, 26 January 2022, para. 153), and the Start-up Strategy called common-

good-oriented enterprises a driver of social innovation (Federal Government of Germany, 28 July 2022, p. 12). This was a poor policy: the statements gave these enterprises a place in the government's vocabulary, but no measure followed.

2.4 SUPPORT: INSTITUTIONAL SUPPORT

Support turned on bodies that measure, advise and connect social enterprises.

2.4.1 KOREA: SVI-BASED CONSULTING AND THE GWANGJU INNOVATION TOWN

MOEL used the SVI to link social enterprises to consulting (MOEL, 15 September 2022, annex 1), and on 30 March MOTIE chose Gwangju for a social economy innovation town, to be built (MOTIE, 8 April 2022, p. 1). This was a mixed policy: SVI-based consulting builds capacity and helps firms show their social performance (Austin et al., 2006), but the town was a decision to build.

2.4.2 JAPAN: THE JFC SUPPORT NETWORK AND DORMANT DEPOSIT BODIES

The JFC's social business support network had 110 members in March and 109 in September (JFC, 30 May 2022, release of 30 May, p. 2, and release of 29 November, p. 1), and the dormant deposits review proposed activity-support organisations (Cabinet Office of Japan, 16 December 2022, p. 9). This was a mixed policy: the network gives hybrid organisations connections to raise money (Doherty et al., 2014), but it did not grow, and the support bodies were a proposal.

2.4.3 CHINA: INCUBATION AND TRAINING FOR SOCIAL ORGANISATIONS

A joint notice of 8 July asked governments to promote incubation bases for social organisations (MCA, MOE, & MOHRSS, 8 July 2022, Part II(5)), and the central grant funded about 37 training projects for their staff (General Office of the Ministry of Civil Affairs, 24 April 2022, plan, Part II(4)). This was a mixed policy: both build capacity, but for social organisations under direction from above rather than for trading social enterprises.

2.4.4 UNITED KINGDOM: THE VCSE CONTRACT READINESS FUND

On 1 September DCMS invited bids to co-design and deliver a programme of up to GBP 900,000 over three financial years to help voluntary, community and social enterprise (VCSE) organisations compete for public contracts (DCMS, 1 September 2022, pp. 2–4). This was a good policy: help with bidding prepares social enterprises for public contracts, though no delivery partner was reported chosen in 2022.

2.4.5 UNITED STATES: CDFI SET-ASIDES IN THE APPROPRIATIONS ACT FOR 2023

The appropriations act for 2023 set aside, within the CDFI line, up to USD 1.6 million for training and outreach, up to USD 2 million for the Economic Mobility Corps, run with the Corporation for National and Community Service, and up to USD 10 million for assistance and training to CDFIs that expand investment benefiting people with disabilities (United States Congress, 29 December 2022, 136 Stat. 4654). This was a good policy: training, technical assistance and national service build the capacity of the community lenders through which social enterprises are financed; its limit is scale.

2.4.6 FRANCE: THE LOCAL SUPPORT SCHEME AND SECRETARY OF STATE

The bill for 2023 gave EUR 11.45 million to the local support scheme (DLA) and EUR 2.23 million to cooperation hubs, money moved from another line (National Assembly of France, 5 October 2022, pp. 8, 11–12); the Secretary of State for the SSE was attached to the Prime Minister (Prime Minister of France, 29 July 2022, Arts. 1–2), and simpler rules for associations were promised (Prime Minister of France, 31 August 2022, p. 35). This was a mixed policy: funded advice and a minister with the Prime Minister give the sector capacity and a voice, but the hubs' money was not new, and the simplification was only announced.

2.4.7 GERMANY: THE BMBF COMMISSIONER AND THE NATIONAL STRATEGY

BMBF appointed a Commissioner for Social Innovations from 1 April (BMBF, 27 April 2022, press release 26/2022), but the strategy on social entrepreneurship promised in the Start-up Strategy was not adopted (Federal Government of Germany, 28 July 2022, pp. 12–13). This was a mixed policy: the commissioner is a point of contact, but the strategy, part of the activism with which social entrepreneurship is more likely (Stephan et al., 2015), remained a promise.

2.5 HUMAN CAPITAL: EDUCATION AND TRAINING, AND LABOUR

Human capital turned on work integration; the skills of social entrepreneurs received little attention.

2.5.1 KOREA: LEAD UNIVERSITIES FOR THE SOCIAL ECONOMY

MOEL and KoSEA selected four lead universities to train about 200 people a year, and MOEL planned a new education model (MOEL, 20 February 2022, pp. 1–2). This was a mixed policy: the courses build the skills that hybrids need to mobilise staff (Doherty et al., 2014), but they are small, and the new model was a plan.

2.5.2 JAPAN: WORKER COOPERATIVES AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP EDUCATION

MHLW presented worker cooperatives as a way to create work where population is falling (MHLW, 3 October 2022, release), and a stronger system for fostering social entrepreneurs through entrepreneurship education was to be considered (Cabinet Office of Japan, 7 June 2022, p. 12). This was a mixed policy: the cooperatives let people create their own jobs, but the education measures were only to be considered.

2.5.3 CHINA: GRADUATE EMPLOYMENT THROUGH SOCIAL ORGANISATIONS

A joint notice of 8 July asked governments to use purchase of services so that social organisations create jobs and internships, with social insurance subsidies for hiring graduates from poor households or with disabilities (MCA, MOE, & MOHRSS, 8 July 2022, Part II(1)–(2)). This was a mixed policy: the jobs, with subsidies for disadvantaged graduates, widen employment, but they direct social organisations to absorb employment rather than build social enterprises.

2.5.4 UNITED KINGDOM: SKILLS UNDER THE CONTRACT READINESS FUND

No measure of 2022 addressed the skills of social entrepreneurs or their staff; the bidding help of the Contract Readiness Fund (DCMS, 1 September 2022, pp. 2–4) is reviewed in Section 2.4.4. This was a poor policy: limited access to skilled staff constrains social enterprises (Doherty et al., 2014), and the government set out nothing for it.

2.5.5 UNITED STATES: ABILITYONE WAGE RULE AND AMERICORPS MATCH

The AbilityOne Commission's rule of 21 July ended subminimum wages on new contracts from 19 October and on existing ones at renewal (U.S. AbilityOne Commission, 21 July 2022, 87 FR 43427–43428); on 5 May AmeriCorps asked whether its match rules deter applicants (AmeriCorps, 5 May 2022, 87 FR 26740). This was a mixed policy: the wage floor is in force for new and renewed contracts, but the match review was a request for information.

2.5.6 FRANCE: WORK INTEGRATION THROUGH ECONOMIC ACTIVITY

The initial Finance Act for 2022 set EUR 1,299.98 million for integration through economic activity (IAE) and the bill for 2023 EUR 1,316.33 million, while the bill cut subsidised contracts by about 10 % (Senate of France, 17 November 2022, IAE table, and section on subsidised contracts). This was a mixed policy: work integration was funded on a large scale, but its 2023 rises are shown only in the bill, which also cut subsidised contracts.

2.5.7 GERMANY: COMMON-GOOD-ORIENTED SPIN-OFFS FROM SCIENCE

The Start-up Strategy promised more support for common-good-oriented spin-offs from science (Federal Government of Germany, 28 July 2022, p. 12); nothing addressed work integration. This was a poor policy: the skills that set social entrepreneurship apart (Austin et al., 2006) received only a promise.

2.6 MARKET: MARKET AND INDUSTRY SUPPORT, IPO AND EXIT

Markets turned on public purchasing; social value in procurement was mostly promised, and exit received no attention.

2.6.1 KOREA: PRIORITY PURCHASING OF SOCIAL ENTERPRISE PRODUCTS

In 2021 public institutions bought 2.77 % of their purchases from social enterprises, but central government bodies only 0.78 %, in a year of large vaccine purchases, and MOEL announced that it would rebuild its online shop (MOEL, 27 April 2022, pp. 1–4). This was a mixed policy: purchasing gives social enterprises a market and brings social aims into public buying (Erridge, 2007), but central bodies bought little, and the rebuild was a promise.

2.6.2 JAPAN: PAY FOR SUCCESS AND THE PROCUREMENT PREFERENCE STUDY

The Cabinet Office counted 100 pay-for-success projects, about 60 % of local governments finding outcome indicators a major issue (Cabinet Office of Japan, 21 July 2022, pp. 1, 3), while a procurement preference for social entrepreneurs was only to be studied (Cabinet Secretariat of Japan, 28 November 2022, p. 19). This was a mixed policy: outcome-based contracts bring social

aims into purchasing, but the evidence on them is limited (Fraser et al., 2018), and the preference was a study.

2.6.3 CHINA: GOVERNMENT PURCHASE OF SERVICES FROM SOCIAL FORCES

The MOF directed that community services such as eldercare and childcare be bought from social forces (MOF, 25 March 2022, Part I(1), (3)). This was a mixed policy: purchase of services creates demand, but with no social value criterion it can favour the commercial goals that, Erridge argues, tend to dominate (Erridge, 2007).

2.6.4 UNITED KINGDOM: PROCUREMENT BILL AND SOCIAL VALUE MODEL

The Procurement Bill, pending at the end of the year, would let buyers reserve competitions for SMEs and social enterprises (Cabinet Office, 12 May 2022, news story); the Social Value Model had applied to central government since January 2021 (DCMS, 1 September 2022, p. 2). This was a mixed policy: reserved competitions would give social aims weight against the commercial goals that tend to dominate procurement (Erridge, 2007), but the Bill was not law.

2.6.5 UNITED STATES: THE ABILITYONE PROCUREMENT LIST AND SIPPRA

Federal agencies must buy listed products from non-profits employing people who are blind or have significant disabilities (U.S. AbilityOne Commission, 21 July 2022, 87 FR 43427), and under the Social Impact Partnerships to Pay for Results Act (SIPPRA) the Treasury published two agreements paying only for verified outcomes (U.S. Department of the Treasury, 24 February 2022, 87 FR 10432, 12221). This was a good policy: a reserved market and payment on evaluated results bring social aims into federal purchasing, though evidence on such contracts is limited (Fraser et al., 2018).

2.6.6 FRANCE: THE NATIONAL PLAN FOR SUSTAINABLE PURCHASING

The plan aimed for 30 % of public contracts to include a social consideration, against 12.5 % in 2019 (Ministry of Ecological Transition, 2022, p. 9); only 34 of 160 local authorities required to adopt a responsible purchasing scheme had done so (Ministry of Ecological Transition, 2022, p. 20). This was a mixed policy: the target gives social enterprises an opening, but the plan is not binding, and most authorities ignored their duty.

2.6.7 GERMANY: COMMON-GOOD-ORIENTED START-UPS IN PROCUREMENT

The Start-up Strategy aimed to raise the visibility of common-good-oriented start-ups in public procurement (Federal Government of Germany, 28 July 2022, p. 13); no procurement rule changed in 2022. This was a poor policy: the aim would counter the commercial goals that, Erridge argues, tend to dominate procurement (Erridge, 2007), but it remained a promise.

3 ANALYSIS OF THE POLICIES

3.1 CONTEXTUAL ANALYSIS: ORIGINS, BACKGROUND AND RATIONALE OF THE POLICIES

France attached a Secretary of State for the SSE to the Prime Minister (Prime Minister of France, 29 July 2022, Arts. 1–2) but held SSE commitments flat, with payments up 7.50 % (National Assembly of France, 5 October 2022, p. 8); the US Congress appropriated USD 324 million for community lenders, and the United Kingdom allocated dormant assets outside the annual budget (Sections 2.2.4 and 2.2.5). Dormant money, social value measures and outcome-based contracts recurred across countries (Section 2), but each government represented the problem in its own way (Table 2).

Table 2: How the governments represented the problem

Country	Problem represented	Presupposition	Left unsaid
Korea	Certification that burdens firms (MOTIE, 21 December 2022, p. 2)	Lighter entry brings in more firms	How purpose is checked
Japan	Social issues as an engine of growth (Cabinet Office of Japan, 7 June 2022, p. 12)	New forms bring growth	Falling NPO borrowing
China	Social organisations to absorb employment (MCA, MOE, & MOHRSS, 8 July 2022, opening)	State direction mobilises society	Trading social enterprises
United Kingdom	Left-behind places (DLUHC, 2 February 2022, p. 216)	Dormant money can replace a strategy	What enterprises need
United States	Distressed communities that need capital (CDFI Fund, 28 October 2022, release)	Mission lenders channel capital	Firms outside finance
France	SSE tools to evaluate, approval to simplify (Prime Minister of France, 31 August 2022, p. 35)	A simpler approval lets the SSE grow	Measures and cost
Germany	Common-good firms at a disadvantage (Federal Government of Germany, 26 January 2022, para. 154)	Removal closes the gap	When, and with what money

Source: IFEED analysis of the sources cited.

3.2 THEORETICAL ANALYSIS: THEORETICAL VALIDITY AND RELEVANCE

Table 3: Theoretical validity of the main policies

Theory	Claim	Policies consistent with it	Policies in tension with it
Institutional support (Stephan et al., 2015)	More likely where activism is higher	CDFI funding (United States); partnership (Korea)	Unspent programme (Germany)
Mission and form (Ebrahim et al., 2014)	Form alone does not stop drift	Stricter certification (United States)	Registration (Korea); no form (Germany)
Resources (Austin et al., 2006; Doherty et al., 2014)	Constraints of money and staff	Partnership, universities (Korea)	No skills measure (United Kingdom, Germany)
Outcome-based contracts (Fraser et al., 2018)	Evidence is limited	Verified results, two projects (United States)	Unspent credits (France); indicators (Japan)
Social procurement (Erridge, 2007)	Commercial goals tend to dominate	Priority purchasing (Korea)	No value criterion (China); plan not binding (France)

Source: IFEED assessment of the policies reviewed in Section 2, against the sources named in the first column.

Stephan et al. (2015) find that social entrepreneurship is more likely where government activism is higher, which US funding fits and Germany's unspent programme does not; Ebrahim et al. (2014) argue that legal form alone does not stop mission drift, and Erridge (2007) that commercial goals tend to crowd out social ones in procurement (Table 3).

3.3 PRACTICAL ANALYSIS: PERFORMANCE, CONTRIBUTION AND IMPACT

Much policy had not reached social enterprises by the end of 2022, and outputs, not contribution, were reported: MOEL compared certified social enterprises' five-year survival, 86.4 % in 2021, with 32.1 % for ordinary firms in 2019, without controlling for selection (MOEL, 21 December 2022, p. 4) (Tables 4 and 5).

Table 4: Status of the main measures at the end of 2022

Country	In force or launched in 2022	Adopted, in force from 2023	Pending or announced
Korea	SVI; partnership; contest; universities; purchasing	—	Registration, shop rebuild (announced); town (decided); training model (planned)
Japan	Cooperatives Act; JFC loans, network; forums; pay for success	—	Form, certification, preference, education (studies); equity, support bodies (proposed)
China	Service purchase; central grant; grades; incubation; graduate jobs	—	Charity Law revision (on the agenda)
United Kingdom	GBP 44 million; readiness competition; Social Value Model	—	Dormant Assets Act 2022 (enacted; commencement by regulations); causes (consulted on); Procurement Bill (pending)
United States	Wage rule (19 October; renewals); appropriations; credits; set-asides; SIPPRA	Elective payment (tax years from 2023)	Certification (previewed); match review (consulted on)
France	SSE line; IAE funding; Secretary of State; purchasing plan	Finance Act (bill figures); report (June 2023)	ESUS simplification (announced)
Germany	KfW cooperative share loans; Commissioner	—	REACT with impact (not started); strategies, pledges (announced)

Source: IFEED compilation from the sources cited in Section 2.

Table 5: Assessment of the policies by domain and country

Domain	Korea	Japan	China	United Kingdom	United States	France	Germany
Regulation and Law	Mixed	Mixed	Mixed	Mixed	Mixed	Mixed	Poor
Finance	Good	Mixed	Mixed	Mixed	Good	Mixed	Mixed
Culture	Good	Mixed	Mixed	Mixed	Poor	Mixed	Poor
Support	Mixed	Mixed	Mixed	Good	Good	Mixed	Mixed
Human Capital	Mixed	Mixed	Mixed	Poor	Mixed	Mixed	Poor
Market	Mixed	Mixed	Mixed	Mixed	Good	Mixed	Poor

Source: IFEED assessment of Section 2. Where a subsection assessed its policies differently, Mixed is shown.

4 POLICY LIMITATIONS

4.1 POLICY DEBATES, CONTESTED POINTS AND ISSUES

The policies of 2022 raised five points of contention (Table 6). The sharpest was whether the State should screen social enterprises or let them in more easily: Korea's plan would replace certification with registration (Section 2.1.1), while the US CDFI Fund moved the other way. In France the rapporteur opposed the SSE credits for 2023 (National Assembly of France, 5 October 2022, p. 6).

Table 6: Debates and contested points in the policies of 2022

Issue	What the governments set out	Point at issue
Screening or easier entry	Registration in place of certification (Korea); stricter certification (United States); certification studied (Japan)	Whether status without screening keeps the mission
Dormant money	Wider scheme enacted, causes undecided (United Kingdom); equity proposed (Japan); use pledged (Germany)	Additionality; who decides the causes
Social value in procurement	Bill pending (United Kingdom); non-binding plan (France); central purchasing low (Korea); preference studied (Japan); promise (Germany)	Price against social value
Legal form	Worker cooperatives (Japan); Charity Law pending (China); tied-assets pledge (Germany)	Form without enforcement
Wages and work integration	Wage floor (United States); bill's cut in subsidised contracts (France)	Who pays for disadvantaged workers

Source: IFEED analysis of the sources cited in Section 2.

4.2 THEORETICAL LIMITATIONS OF THE POLICIES

The first limitation is announcement as a substitute for support: Germany's strategies, programme and legal pledges, Japan's studies and the British promise to consider the social economy did not deliver the activism with which social entrepreneurship is more likely (Stephan et al., 2015). The second is status without governance: Korea's plan would keep a status while dropping much of its screening, and form or status without governance does not prevent mission drift (Ebrahim et al., 2014). The third is measurement: Korea's SVI and the British Social Value Model measure what sets social entrepreneurship apart (Austin et al., 2006), but they select firms and bids rather than evaluate policies. Finally, reliance on lenders, social organisations and cooperatives leaves out enterprises that trade for social aims.

5 POLICY IMPLICATIONS

First, announced support should be delivered. Social entrepreneurship is more likely where government activism is higher (Section 3.2), and in 2022 much of that activism was promised: Germany's programme for social enterprises spent nothing by October, its strategy was not adopted, and most new British dormant money had no causes. Governments should fund social enterprise through commitments with stated amounts and dates, as the US appropriations and Korea's partnership do, and report what they spend.

Second, status should come with screening and enforcement. Korea's registration system, any form for Germany's common-good-oriented enterprises and Japan's corporate form for private bodies with public roles should specify who checks that assets stay locked and missions are kept; Japan's specified worker cooperatives and the US certification tests for CDFIs show two ways to do so.

Third, public purchasing should weigh social value and be open to small suppliers. The British Procurement Bill should be enacted, Korea should raise purchasing by central bodies, France should make its responsible purchasing schemes a duty that authorities keep, and Japan and Germany should turn their studies and promises into rules.

Fourth, finance should draw in private money on terms investors accept, as US tax credits and Korea's partnership with private money do, and outcome-based contracts should expand only with outcome measures that buyers can set.

Finally, policy should measure outcomes, not outputs. Counts of certifications, loans, awards and allocations do not show whether social enterprises reached the people and problems for which they were supported. Korea's certification and purchasing, the US awards to community development lenders and France's work integration aid should be evaluated against what would have happened without them, and the results published.

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